

# MGT10009

## Assignment 3: Individual Report

### Canberra Raiders

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## Executive Summary

The purpose of this report is to identify and analyse a driver of competitive advantage for the Canberra Raiders. It also aims to apply two management principles that can contribute to increased performance through the driver of competitive advantage.

The Canberra Raiders are one of 17 teams competing within the National Rugby League. They exist within a rapidly evolving competitive landscape with extremely limited new entrants.

The key findings of this report show that:

- Due to the importance of customer retention within the Raiders industry, it was found that the driver competitive advantage which would have the most favourable impact on the Canberra was service.
- Increasing organisational adaptability through the management practise of organisational structure would assist the Raiders in adapting to the ever-evolving competitive landscape the organisation resides within. This would help them achieve a service-based competitive advantage as it would help them adapt to changes in customer demands and the industry before their competitors
- Improving workplace culture would be highly beneficial in assisting the Raiders in achieving a service-based competitive advantage due to the increased customer satisfaction derived from more effective employees.

The concluding recommendation for the Raiders to achieve a service-based competitive advantage were:

- 1- To increase organisational adaptability through the implementation of self-organising teams to improve its responsiveness to industrial change.
- 2- The implementation of compulsory leader training which would improve overall employee effectiveness and in turn, customer satisfaction.

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## Introduction

The purpose of this report is to identify an additional driver of competitive advantage for the Canberra Raiders and then to apply two key management practices to contribute to sustained and superior performance of the organisation through the identified competitive driver.

It should be noted that the competitive driver of innovation and sustainability were ruled out due to their use in the previous assignment.

This report will first analyse the competitive environment of the Raiders. It will then discuss the competitive driver of service and the benefits it offers to the Raiders. The report will then apply the two management practices of structure and culture and analyse how they can help the Raiders achieve the competitive advantage of service. The report will then conclude, followed up with recommendations for the Raiders in context of the competitive driver and management practises.

## Competitive environment analysis

The Canberra Raiders exist within a tightly controlled market that is overseen by the NRL.

The Canberra Raiders are one of the 17 teams competing in the National Rugby League.

Going beyond the scope of just the NRL competition, the Canberra Raiders are also in competition with sporting organisations of other sports, such as the AFL's GWS Giants.

The sport administration and entertainment industries are quickly evolving. Many factors play into this such as:

- The increased investment into fan data (Giorgio, 2024, p. 6)
- Government intervention
- Rapid evolution of commercial models, such as sports gambling (Giorgio, 2024, p. 4)
- Increased use of artificial intelligence (Giorgio, 2024, p. 8)

Due to these factors, the Raiders and their competitors exist within rapidly evolving competitive landscape. This presents itself as both an opportunity and a threat to all members of this competitive landscape as the speed and success when adapting to the various changes will have a significant impact on all firms within the industry.

The team itself has many buyers it can sell to. Fans of the club will purchase their products and services, that being the entertainment their players provide through ticket sales, memberships and merchandise. The club also owns and operates various licenced clubs and building developments across the Canberra region which it uses to provide a diversified revenue stream.

New entrants to the Raiders market are limited due to the NRL's team licencing system, where new teams cannot be created in the league without being approved by the NRL, which is a very costly process. On top of this, establishing a new NRL team is a costly

process in of itself, with the prospective Papua New Guinean team estimated to cost \$600 million to establish (Lowrey, 2024).

## Service-Based Competitive Advantage

The chosen competitive driver for this report is service. The service competitive driver can be defined as an entity giving customers what they desire, when they desire it (Bateman & Snell, 2022). Service is an extremely important aspect of business, this is because research has found that customers who interpret the service they're receiving positively are far more likely to feel engaged and energised after the transaction has taken place, showing increased overall satisfaction (Calvert et al., 2019, p. 10). Further research has shown a customer having a negative experience with an entity means they are far less likely to be satisfied with the good or service they receive and will avoid dealing with the entity in the future (Majeed et al., 2022, p. 13). Thus, bad service is to be avoided as it alienates consumers whilst good service is favourable as it encourages loyal customers. In this context, a service-based competitive advantage would mean a firm is able to deliver better service than that of its competitors, meaning consumers will choose to deal with the firm which offers better service and a higher level of overall consumer satisfaction.

The service competitive driver was chosen for the Raiders due to the importance of fan retention within the sporting industry. Within their competitive market, it is important for the Raiders to capture new consumers, and keep their old fans loyal to achieve a safe level of growth. The service competitive driver is a pivotal aspect in this goal as overall service satisfaction is directly linked to customer retention and the likelihood of consumers recommending a service to others within the sporting industry (Javadein et al., 2008, p. 13). In the case of the Raiders, prioritising the service competitive driver may result in a fan successfully recommending a newcomer to the sport to follow their team, it will also ensure that both old and new fans remain loyal to the club as their perceived satisfaction with the entity will be higher. This would be highly beneficial to the club as it will result in new consumers of their products whilst also ensuring the current consumers are not convinced to switch to substitute products, such as those offered by other NRL teams.

# Management practices

## Organisational Structure

One management practise that will assist the Raiders in establishing and maintaining a service based competitive advantage is that of structure. Organisational structure is a broad term that encapsulates the way in which an entity has differentiated the various roles within it and the reporting structure of said roles.

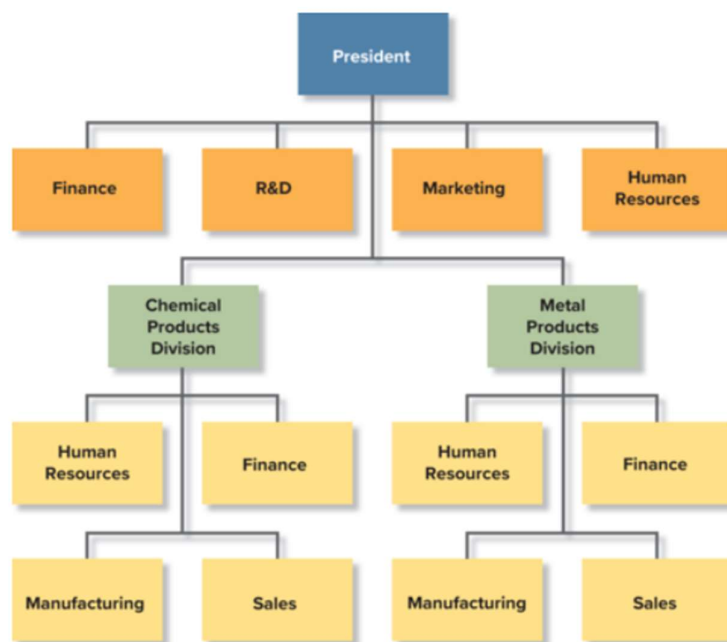


Figure 1 illustrates the structure of a traditional organisation via an organisational chart (Bateman & Snell, 2022, p. 230).

Organisational structure is important as it provides employees with a clear understanding of their roles, goals and responsibilities, it also creates a hierarchy of decision-making capabilities that illustrates who they answer to and who answers to them (Bateman & Snell, 2022, p. 236).



In the context of the Raiders, creating an organisational structure that prioritises the maximisation of consumer satisfaction would be highly beneficial to the firm. As the Raiders exist within a fast-changing competitive environment, high levels of responsiveness to changes in said environment would help distinguish them from their competition. Both fast and high-quality decisions within firms are difficult to achieve, although research has shown that these have a profound impact on organisational performance (Shepherd et al., 2023, p. 690). This would be possible to achieve through the adoption of an organic business structure. An organic business structure is an adaptive business structure that allows for a high level of responsiveness to their customers wants and needs through decentralised decision-making capabilities (Bateman & Snell, 2022, p. 261). This would assist the Raiders in establishing a service-based competitive advantage as they would be able to adapt to changes in the industry before their competitors.

## Organisational Culture

Another management practice that can assist the Raiders in establishing a clear competitive advantage in relation to service is that of the organisational culture. An organisation's culture can best be explained as a system of shared values and beliefs within members of the organisation (Bateman & Snell, 2022, p. 58).

Organisational culture is an important part of establishing a service based competitive advantage. This is because fostering a positive organisational workplace culture amplifies the performance of a firm's employees, in turn increasing overall consumer satisfaction derived from the service they are capable of providing (Radu, 2024, p. 8). This demonstrates the importance organisational culture in achieving a service based competitive advantage.

In the context of the Raiders, building a strong culture around providing excellent service to its fans and members would be highly beneficial to the entity. This is because it would allow the Raiders to foster fan loyalty through strong customer relationships, as their customers

would feel more satisfied when utilising the goods and services the team provides.

Research has shown that loyal customers are more likely to partake in positive word-of-mouth marketing, which would entice prospective fans to support the Raiders (Rane et al., 2024, p. 428). For example, someone who has recently moved to Canberra could be convinced to support the Raiders due to the recommendation of a current fan. This would help the Raiders establish a service based competitive edge as their superior workplace culture and customer relations will promote loyalty amongst current fans and attract new ones as well. In the long term, this would allow the Raiders to enjoy higher profits and financial stability as they have a more robust and loyal fan base to sell their goods and services to.

## Conclusion

This report analysed the competitive environment of the Canberra Raiders. It discussed the Raiders suppliers, buyers, their competition and possible new entrants to their market. It also discussed how the sporting entertainment and administration industry is rapidly evolving.

It then analysed the service-based driver of competitive advantage and its impact on the firm, it found they had a significant impact due to the importance of customer satisfaction in fan retention.

Following this, the management principles of structure was analysed, it discussed the importance of organisational adaptability in an ever-evolving industry that would help the Raiders achieve a service-based competitive advantage.

The report then analysed the management principle of culture, it discussed the benefits exceptional workplace culture has in increasing consumer satisfaction, which would help the Raiders achieve a service-based competitive advantage.

## Recommendations

One way the Raiders could achieve a service based competitive advantage is by utilising a more dynamic business structure which decentralises decision making. The adoption of self-organising team, which is a team that does not wait for a manager to assign them work and instead will conduct the work they deem most important whilst still managing responsibilities assigned to them would help increase the responsiveness of the Raiders to industry-wide changes (Westover, 2024). This would allow employees of the firm to quickly adapt to industry changes and better meet the evolving demands of the firm's consumers, helping the Raiders establish a service-based competitive advantage as they will be more capable of meeting the demand of consumers than their competitors.

Another way the Raiders could achieve a service based competitive edge is by improving organisational culture. Various method such as the introduction of compulsory leader training can result in improved employee wellbeing (Carrier, 2016, p. 25). Improved employee wellbeing would make employees more committed to their roles, thus boosting organisational performance and in turn improving the service the organisation is able to provide (Zhenjing et al., 2022, p.9). This would ultimately assist the Raiders in achieving a service based competitive advantage as they are able to better satisfy the wants and needs of their customers when compared to their competitors.

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